
Round-Up Investing

OPPORTUNITY VALIDATION

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<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1tUGD9TDWC5jvmPTNDzJ3upuV08Ofv8W8GG8feWukAFg/edit?usp=sharing>

The brief you've been handed.

A leader has handed you the following feature idea, a couple of paragraphs straight from the tip of the iceberg. Everything you build in this assignment starts here.

FEATURE BRIEF 01

Product. A consumer wealth-and-payments app (UPI plus investing), India, roughly 8M monthly active users, mostly ages 22 to 35.

Feature idea, "Round-Up Investing".

"Every time a user makes a UPI payment, we round the amount up to the next ₹10 and quietly invest the spare change into a low-risk fund. Pay ₹47 for a coffee, ₹3 goes into investing. The pitch is that people who never start investing because it feels intimidating, or because they 'never have money left over', will start building a corpus without noticing. I keep seeing young users who use us daily for payments but have never opened an investment. I think this is our bridge. Can you look into whether this is worth building, whether users actually want it, and whether it moves our numbers?"

What the leader did not specify. Who exactly this is for, how big the problem really is, what people do today instead, or what "moves our numbers" means. That's your job.

This is the brief for everyone. Work on it in your own time and submit the completed document.

MANAGER BRIEFING

A1 · Strategic fit

Element	Your entry
Mission, tweaked to this feature	Make wealth-building more accessible by helping everyday users take simple, low-friction steps toward investing.
Vision, tweaked to this feature	Make investing a natural part of everyday money management, as familiar and habitual as making everyday payments.
Company strategy <i>Current priorities this feature must sit inside</i>	Use the existing payments relationship to expand users' engagement with the company's financial products, reducing friction between everyday payments and wealth-building. Current priorities this feature must sit inside: Growing investing MAU and increasing AUM from the existing payments user base. Round-Up Investing sits inside the investment activation workstream, converting payment-only users into investors without requiring them to seek out financial products independently.
Product strategy <i>What the product is optimizing for now</i>	Convert existing payment engagement into meaningful engagement with the app's wealth-building products by making investing easier to start and integrate into everyday money management.
Team goals <i>The specific metrics your team owns</i>	1. Increase conversion rate of existing UPI users into first-time investors via Round-Up activation. 2. Increase retention of newly activated investors at 30, 60, and 90 days post-activation. 3. Increase repeat investment behaviour; measured as the % of Round-Up users making consistent micro-investments over a rolling 30-day period. 4. Grow average corpus size per Round-Up investor (AUM per user), tracking whether the feature builds meaningful financial value over time. 5. Contribute to platform revenue through fund management fees or commission on AUM generated via Round-Up.
Manager's yes/no and notes <i>Filled after the briefing conversation</i>	To be completed after the manager briefing conversation.

A2 · User value hypothesis

BLOCK 1 · USER PROFILE HYPOTHESIS

Demographic (B2C) or firmographic (B2B) <i>Age, location, income, occupation, or company type and size</i>	Salaried adults, 22 - 35 years old, living in Tier 1 or Tier 2 Indian cities, earning ₹25,000 - ₹80,000 per month. Income is regular but after rent, food, and daily expenses, the perceived investable surplus feels too small to act on not because they are financially distressed, but because small amounts don't feel worth the effort of a conscious investing decision.
Product behaviour and usage pattern <i>How they use the product today, and what is unique about their usage</i>	High-frequency UPI users making 15 or more transactions per month through the app for daily payments (food, transport, utility bills, peer transfers). They have never activated any investment product on the platform. They are aware investing exists on the app but have not taken a first step. Their primary mental model of the app is as a payments tool, not a financial product.

BLOCK 2 · USER PROBLEM HYPOTHESIS

Problem area <i>Which part of their experience hurts</i>	High-frequency UPI users have a latent intention to invest but consistently fail to act on it. The barrier is not lack of interest but lack of a low-effort entry point because starting investing requires a deliberate decision (choosing an app, selecting a fund, deciding an amount) that these users keep deprioritising.
Signals of the problem <i>Complaints, social chatter, behaviour you have seen</i>	Signals include: • The leader's direct observation that a significant portion of the app's payment-active users have never opened an investment product. • The growth of Jar, an Indian micro-saving app built on the same mechanic, to 10M+ users in the same demographic. • Groww's first-time-investor GTM succeeding at scale, confirming that cognitive friction is a real and large barrier. • Recurring Reddit India and Twitter discussions from young salaried adults asking how to begin investing with small amounts.
Severity	Primarily a trust and values issue. The barrier is not a broken

<i>Quality issue, or a trust and values issue?</i>	product experience the app's payments function works. The friction is identity-level: users don't see themselves as investors yet. Additionally, the Round-Up mechanic introduces a trust risk: automatic deduction of funds without per-transaction consent requires high baseline trust in the platform. Severity increases significantly if users discover unexpected deductions before developing trust in the feature.
Estimated number of users impacted <i>A range is fine, from immersion, not precise data</i>	The estimated target group is around 4 to 5.5 million users. This represents roughly 50% to 65% of the app's 8 million Monthly Active Users (MAUs) who regularly use the app for payments but haven't tried any investment products yet. Currently, this number is an educated guess based on general product observation rather than hard data. Our very first step should be to validate these numbers by pulling the actual data to compare users who only make payments against those who invest.
Alternatives used today <i>What do they do instead, without you?</i>	Users currently: • Postpone investing entirely with no alternative action. • Make occasional lump-sum investments when they feel they have surplus, thus making it irregular and low-frequency. • Use separate apps such as Groww, Zerodha, or Jar for investing, keeping the payment app and investment app mentally separate. The proposed approach: Round-Up Investing embedded in UPI transactions replaces all of these by making investing automatic, passive, and tied to an existing daily behaviour.

BLOCK 3 · USER GOALS HYPOTHESIS

Qualitative goals <i>What a good outcome feels like for the user</i>	Users feel like they have become investors without having had to make a difficult financial decision. The emotional win is discovering they have already started building a corpus, not feeling more equipped to make complex investing choices.
Quantitative goals <i>What would drop or rise for them</i>	The amount accumulated in the Round-Up corpus over time. The measurable win for the user is watching a real number grow from their existing transactions: first ₹500, then ₹2,000, then eventually ₹10,000, without any deliberate investing effort.
Non-goals <i>What you we explicitly not solving</i>	• Not to provide financial education, investment planning, or advisory content. The feature is designed to work without the user needing to understand what they are investing in or why.

	• Not to offer fund selection, portfolio customisation, or investment controls beyond a basic on/off toggle. Introducing choice brings back exactly the decision friction the feature is trying to remove. • Not to become the user's primary investment channel. Round-Up is intended as a first step into investing behaviour, not a complete wealth management solution.
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A3 · Business value hypothesis

BLOCK 1 · KEY STAKEHOLDERS

Decision makers <i>Who must sign off</i>	Product leadership, Wealth and Investment product leadership, Risk and Compliance, Legal (consent architecture, SEBI regulatory alignment, and auto-deduction obligations), and Finance or Business leadership responsible for P&L and the revenue model.
Informed circle <i>Who needs to be told or trained but does not approve</i>	Customer Support (handling user queries about unexpected deductions), Marketing and CRM (activation and communication), UX and Research, Data and Analytics, Engineering (feasibility and cost inputs), and Investment Operations (fund reconciliation and AUM management; operational dependency, not approver).

BLOCK 2 · BUSINESS GOALS

Goal type	Your entry	Lever it maps to
Qualitative goals	Establish the app as a trusted entry point into investing for payment-active users, increasing its role in users' financial lives beyond transactions. A user who invests through the app is more engaged, harder to churn, and more likely to adopt additional financial products.	Users engage more + Users renew and retain more
Quantitative goals <i>Estimated ranges, from immersion</i>	• 15 to 25 percent of payment-active users activate Round-Up within 6 months of launch, creating a new investing cohort with near-zero acquisition cost since these users are already on the platform. • Trail commission income from AUM	<i>Users engage more, Users renew and retain more, Users pay more (via</i>

	accumulated via Round-Up, estimated at 0.5 to 1 percent annually on the total corpus across activated users. • Measurable drop in churn rate among users who activate both UPI and Round-Up, compared to payment-only users. • Higher cross-sell conversion rate: Round-Up users converting to SIP or lumpsum products within 90 days of activation.	<i>cross-sell)</i>
Non-goals <i>Business outcomes you are explicitly not chasing</i>	• Not a primary user acquisition driver. The feature activates existing users, it does not bring new ones in. Any new installs driven by word-of-mouth are a secondary upside, not a goal this feature is accountable for. • Not competing on AUM scale with dedicated investment platforms like Groww or Zerodha. The business value here is engagement depth and cross-sell probability, not total assets managed. • Not a replacement for deliberate investment products. Round-Up is a gateway, and the business should not negatively impact SIP or lumpsum product revenue by positioning Round-Up as sufficient on its own.	No lever as these are explicit exclusions

INTERVIEW PLAN

B1 · The hypothesis to interview on

Profile hypothesis	Salaried adults, 22 - 35 years old, in Tier 1 or Tier 2 Indian cities, earning ₹25,000 - ₹80,000 per month. After daily expenses, their perceived investable surplus feels too small to act on not because they are financially distressed, but because small amounts don't feel worth the effort of a conscious investing decision. They make 15 or more UPI transactions per month on the app, are aware investing exists on the platform, but have never taken a first step. Their primary mental model of the app is as a payments tool, not a financial product.
Problem hypothesis	These users have a latent intention to invest but consistently fail to act on it. The barrier is not lack of interest but lack of a low-effort entry point; and starting investing requires a deliberate decision about which app, which fund, and how much, and that decision keeps getting deprioritised. The Round-Up mechanic hypothesises that removing this decision entirely will convert intention into behaviour.
Goals hypothesis	Users feel like they have become investors without having had to make a difficult financial decision. The emotional win is discovering they have already started building a corpus. The measurable win is watching a real number grow from existing transactions i.e., first ₹500, then ₹2,000, then eventually ₹10,000, without any deliberate investing effort.

B2 · Define your 6 users

Common attributes <i>Shared by all six, from your profile hypothesis</i>	Salaried adult, 22 - 35 years old, in a Tier 1 or Tier 2 Indian city, earning ₹25,000 - ₹80,000 per month. Makes 15 or more UPI transactions per month on the app. Has never activated an investment product on the platform. Is aware investing exists on the app but has not taken a first step.
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#	Age band	Gender	Location	Income / family	Peculiar habit	Persona in one line
1.	22 - 25	Female	Bengaluru	₹30K - ₹40K /	Transfers whatever is left at month-end	She wants to start investing but

				Lives alone	into a savings account, but never invests it.	keeps postponing it because the amount she can set aside feels too small.
2.	26 - 29	Male	Pune	₹45K - ₹55K / Lives with partner	Has researched mutual funds and watched investing videos several times but has never actually invested.	He knows enough about investing to want to start, but keeps getting stuck at the point of making a decision.
3.	30 - 35	Female	Hyderabad	₹60K - ₹75K / Married	Has a monthly budget spreadsheet with a line item labelled "Investing - TBD" that she has been leaving blank for several months.	She has already decided investing belongs in her plan but has never taken the step to activate it.
4.	23 - 26	Male	Jaipur	₹25K - ₹35K / Lives with family	Opens his UPI transaction history at month-end, feels surprised by how much he spent on small purchases, then closes the app and does nothing with that information.	He is already aware of where his money goes but that awareness has never translated into any investing action.
5.	27 - 30	Female	Mumbai	₹50K - ₹65K / Supports family	Sets aside money on salary day for specific goals but does not want to decide where to invest it.	She already saves regularly but sees investing as a separate, more complicated activity.
6.	30 - 35	Female	Lucknow	₹60K/month; married, two-person household	Uses UPI extensively and regularly rounds up expenses mentally, but never follows through on turning the accumulated amount into an investment	A user who already thinks in small savings increments but has not converted that behaviour into investing.

B3 · The recruitment funnel

Channel	Response rate assumed	People to reach	Interested needed	Screened needed	Scheduled needed	Incentive
In-app notification	5%	~5,300	~265	~80	8	₹500 UPI cashback on participation

Screening questions: *Two or three that check your peculiar habits, not demographics*

Q1: Walk me through what you typically do with your money in the first couple of days after your salary comes in. What's your usual process?

Pass: Pays bills, transfers to savings, leaves a remainder in the account with no specific plan, or describes an informal or unintentional process for the leftover amount.

Screen out: Sets up SIPs immediately, invests a fixed allocation on salary day, or describes a systematic investing routine that already runs without friction.

Q2: Think about the last time you looked at how much you had spent or what was left in your account. What did you do next?

Pass: Noticed the amount but moved on without acting, transferred informally to savings with no further decision, felt they should be doing more but did nothing specific.

Screen out: Immediately invested the surplus, has automatic investing that handles this, or does not track spending at all because investments are already automated.

Q3: Has there been a point in the last few months where you thought about investing or putting money away more seriously, but didn't end up doing it? What was going on?

Pass: Yes, kept postponing; felt the amount was too small to bother; didn't know where to start; got busy and never came back to it.

Screen out: Already invests regularly and has no intention gap; has never thought about investing and shows no latent intent; or actively does not want to invest.

B4 · The staged interview guide

STAGE 1 Build psychological safety (about 5 min)

Opening (before warm-up prompts):

Hi [participant name], thank you for making time today. My name is [your name], and I'm on the product team at [app name]. We're speaking to people who use the app regularly to understand how they think about and manage their money day to day. We're not testing any specific feature, and there are no right or wrong answers. I'm here purely to learn from your experience.

Before we start, would it be okay if I record this session for internal use only? The recording will only be seen by our research team and won't be shared anywhere externally. You can ask me to stop at any point.

[Wait for verbal confirmation before starting the recording.]

Prompt 1: Tell me a little about what a typical weekday looks like for you.

Prompt 2: What are some of the things you usually use UPI for?

Prompt 3: When you're not working, what do you usually like doing?

STAGE 2 Immerse in context (about 10 min)

Prompt 1: Recent money-left-over event

Think about the last time you had some money left after covering your regular expenses. What did you do with it?

Prompt 2: Recent saving event

Think about the last time you deliberately set some money aside. Walk me through what you did.

Prompt 3: Recent income-distribution event

Think about the last time you received your salary. Walk me through what happened to your money in the first two or three days.

Prompt 4: Recent app-adoption event

Think about the time you signed up for something new on your phone like an app, a subscription, anything. What made you go through with it?

Prompt 5: Recent small-payment event

Think about a recent day when you made several small UPI payments. What were they for, and what did you do with the money that remained in your account?

STAGE 3 Real validation questions (30 to 45 min)

Prompt 1: Think about the last time you tried to start investing. What did you do?

Prompt 2: Walk me through exactly what you did next after that point. For example, did you take any steps, and if so where did it go from there?

Prompt 3: Walk me through the last time you had to make a financial decision that felt genuinely hard. What was the situation?

Prompt 4: Think about the last time you had a relatively small amount of money available that you could have saved or invested. What did you do with it?

Prompt 5: Think about the last time you decided that an amount of money was too small to be worth doing something with. What did you do instead?

Prompt 6: Think about the most recent time you told yourself you would start investing later. What happened?

Prompt 7: Think about the last time you chose not to do something with your money because it felt like too much effort. What happened?

Prompt 8: Think about the last time you used this app for something other than making a payment. What were you trying to get done, and how did it go?

Prompt 9: If someone told you that over the last 6 months you had quietly accumulated ₹2,000 toward a savings goal without doing anything deliberately; what would your first reaction be?

Prompt 10: Have you ever had any automatic deduction set up on your account like an EMI, a subscription, anything? How did you feel about money moving without you actively doing it each time?

Required tool step (Ayuda Question Rewriter)

Original question	Tests it failed	Rewritten question
Think about the last time	Leading, One idea	Walk me through the last

you decided that an amount of money was too small to be worth doing something with. What did you do instead?		time you came across a small amount of money that you did not know what to do with. What was the situation and what did you decide?
If someone told you that over the last 6 months you had quietly accumulated ₹2,000 toward a savings goal without doing anything deliberately; what would your first reaction be?	Leading, Behavior vs opinion, Time-anchored	Think back to the last time you realized money had moved — been spent, saved, or transferred — without you actively deciding it. Walk me through what happened and what went through your mind when you noticed it.
Have you ever had any automatic deduction set up on your account like an EMI, a subscription, anything? How did you feel about money moving without you actively doing it each time?	One idea, Time-anchored	Walk me through the last time you noticed money had left your account automatically — what were you doing, and what happened next?
Think about the last time you had a relatively small amount of money available that you could have saved or invested. What did you do with it?	Time-anchored	Walk me through the last time you had a bit of extra money you didn't already have a plan for — what happened, and how did you decide what to do with it?
Think about the most recent time you told yourself you would start investing later. What happened?	Leading, Behavior vs opinion	Walk me through the last time you thought about putting money aside for the future — what was going on, and what did you do?

DESIGN METHOD PLAN

C1 · Interview or design method

Both interviews and a design method, with interviews as the primary method.

Against the criteria: the feature is simple and tied to daily UPI behaviour, which supports interviews. However, the target users are not immersed in investing; it is an unfamiliar category for them which means seeing a concept will surface reactions that questions alone cannot. We have sufficient time to run both methods. And while we are reasonably confident in the problem hypothesis, we are less confident about two things: whether the Round-Up mechanism feels intuitive, and whether automatic deduction of funds triggers a trust concern before users develop confidence in the feature. Interviews will validate whether the problem exists and what behaviour underlies it. The design method will follow, showing a simple Round-Up concept to test whether the mechanism feels useful, understandable, and trustworthy.

C2 · Set the three knobs

Activity	Stimulus and fidelity	Role	Pairing valid?
Give reactions	Vibe-prototype, as it shows UPI transaction completing, "₹7 auto-invested" notification appearing, and accumulated balance screen	Guide	Yes, "Give reactions" pairs with Observer or Guide

C3 · Spec the stimulus

What's in the stimulus	Four screens covering the complete Round-Up user journey. The first is the opt-in screen. It shows a single toggle labelled "Enable Round-Up Investing" with one line of plain language below it: "Every UPI payment you make will be rounded up to the next ₹10. The spare
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	change goes into a low-risk fund automatically." No fund selection, no amount input. This tests whether users understand what they are signing up for and whether a single toggle feels like enough control to feel safe. The second is a UPI payment completion screen showing a standard post-payment confirmation (e.g., ₹47 paid to Swiggy) with a Round-Up line added inline: "₹3 rounded up and invested." This tests whether the deduction is visible, understandable, and whether seeing it alongside a real transaction triggers alarm or comfort. The third is a post-transaction notification reading: "₹3 auto-invested into your Round-Up fund. Total saved: ₹2,340." This is the direct test of the trust hypothesis. Does a notification about automatic fund movement feel like a helpful update or a security alert? The fourth is an accumulated balance screen showing the corpus total (₹2,340), a breakdown of recent round-up transactions, and a single line confirming the fund type. No returns chart, no fund performance data. This tests whether the accumulation creates the emotional win described in the goals hypothesis. One session note: the opt-in screen will be time-boxed. The trust signal we most need to observe comes from the notification and balance screens, so we will move through activation quickly and spend more time on screens two and three.
What's out, deliberately excluded	Fund selection or comparison screens are out. Introducing fund choice reintroduces exactly the decision friction the feature is designed to remove. This was called out explicitly in A2 non-goals, and testing it here would validate a different, more complex feature. Returns and performance charts are out. The value proposition is corpus accumulation through passive habit, not investment returns. Showing performance data introduces financial expectations that are out of scope for this validation. Financial education or explainer content is out. This is an explicit non-goal from A2. The feature must work without users needing to understand what they are investing in, and including education content would make the stimulus feel more complex than the actual product. Customisation options beyond the on/off toggle are out. Amount controls, round-up caps, and fund preferences bring back decision-making friction. If users ask for these during the session, that is a finding to capture, not something to pre-build into the stimulus. The withdrawal and redemption flow is out. Including it risks shifting the session toward liquidity anxiety rather than activation behaviour, which is not what this test is for.

Fidelity level chosen	Vibe-prototype, realistic visual fidelity, no real backend.
Why this fidelity <i>Matched to how strong your hypothesis is</i>	Our hypothesis confidence is uneven, and the fidelity decision follows directly from that gap. The problem hypothesis (latent intention, no low-effort entry point) is reasonably confident. Jar's scale, Groww's GTM, and the leader's own user observation all support it. That hypothesis does not need high-fidelity stimulus to test. The two hypotheses with low confidence are what set the fidelity floor: whether the round-up mechanism feels intuitive, and whether automatic deduction triggers a trust concern before users have built any confidence in the feature. Both of these require visual realism to surface genuine reactions. A wireframe will not trigger a real trust response to a line reading "₹3 auto-debited." Users will mentally fill in a polished version and react to the product they imagined, not the one in front of them. A vibe-prototype with realistic typography, rupee amounts, notification styling, and a real-looking payment screen forces users to react to the actual experience. A fully coded product is unnecessary. No real fund transaction needs to be processed, and the activity chosen in C2 is Give Reactions, not Use the Stimulus, so backend behaviour is not being tested. Vibe-prototype sits at exactly the right fidelity for where our hypothesis confidence stands.

C4 · The design-method process document

How will you share the stimulus? <i>Link, tracked via Clarity, shared in advance or on the call</i>	Via a link sent in the chat during the call, not shared in advance. Sending it early risks users forming reactions before immersion has primed them with real behavioural memory. The link opens the hosted vibe-prototype covering the four screens from C3. Clarity is embedded as a supplementary layer to capture screen-by-screen pause patterns, but it is not the primary insight source. The activity is Give Reactions and the role is Guide, so verbal output carries the session. Clarity supplements by flagging where users slow down or re-read without narrating it.
What exactly will you say to set up the activity?	"I'm going to share a link in the chat now. It'll take you through a few screens from an app. Go through them at your own pace and just talk out loud as you go; whatever you're noticing, what you understand, what feels confusing, what you like, what feels off. There are no right answers. I didn't build this, so you genuinely cannot hurt my feelings.

	I'll mostly stay quiet and let you explore. If you go quiet for a bit I'll just check in and ask you to keep talking." This sets three things correctly: it does not reveal the feature name or hypothesis, it gives the participant a clear task, and it pre-empts social desirability bias with the "you can't hurt my feelings" line.
How will you hold your chosen role consistently?	Guide speaks only when the participant goes silent. The role is not to explain, fill gaps, or react to what they say. Before the session, prepare exactly three neutral intervention phrases so you never reach for a leading question under pressure: 1. "Keep going, whatever's on your mind." 2. "What's going through your head right now?" 3. "What would you expect to happen next?" Hard rules for the Guide role: If they ask what a screen or feature does, reflect it back: "What do you think it does?" Never explain a screen even if their interpretation is wrong. Wrong interpretations are findings. Never use words like "trust", "safe", "worried", or "automatic". These are your hypothesis words and they will anchor the user's reaction. Note verbatim reactions against the screen number they were on, not paraphrased summaries.

SYNTHESIS SETUP

D1 · Background, hypothesis details

Hypothesis ID	Validation method	Hypothesis description
HYP01	Interview	The target user is a salaried adult, 22 to 35 years old, living in a Tier 1 or Tier 2 Indian city, earning between ₹25,000 and ₹80,000 per month. They make 15 or more UPI transactions per month through the app and have never activated an investment product on the platform. Their primary mental model of the app is as a payments tool, not a financial product. They perceive the investable surplus available to them as too small to act on, not because they are financially constrained, but because small amounts do not feel worth the effort of a deliberate investing decision.
HYP02	Interview	These users have a latent intention to invest but consistently fail to act on it. The barrier is not lack of interest. It is the absence of a low-effort entry point. Starting investing requires a deliberate decision about which app to use, which fund to pick, and how much to put in. That decision keeps getting deprioritised.
HYP03	Interview + Design method	A good outcome for the user is feeling like they have become an investor without having had to make a difficult financial decision. The emotional win is discovering they have already started building a corpus. The measurable win is watching a real accumulated number grow from their existing transactions, from first ₹500, then ₹2,000, then eventually ₹10,000, without any deliberate investing effort.
HYP04	Design method	The Round-Up mechanism, which automatically deducts spare change without per-transaction consent, does not trigger a trust or security concern when surfaced correctly as a round-up notification. Users with no prior investing experience will read an auto-deduction as a feature confirmation, not a fraud or security alert.

D2 · Background, target audience

Persona ID	Common attributes	Unique traits	Demographic traits
P1	Salaried adult, 22 - 35, Tier 1 or Tier 2 city, ₹25K - ₹80K/month, 15+ UPI transactions/month on the app, investing-aware but never activated any investment product.	Transfers whatever is left at month-end into a savings account, but never invests it. Postpones investing because the amount feels too small to act on.	Female, 22 - 25, Bengaluru, ₹30K - ₹40K/month, lives alone.
P2	Salaried adult, 22 - 35, Tier 1 or Tier 2 city, ₹25K - ₹80K/month, 15+ UPI transactions/month on the app, investing-aware but never activated any investment product.	Has researched mutual funds and watched investing videos multiple times but has never actually invested. Gets stuck at the point of making a decision.	Male, 26 - 29, Pune, ₹45K - ₹55K/month, lives with partner.
P3	Salaried adult, 22 - 35, Tier 1 or Tier 2 city, ₹25K - ₹80K/month, 15+ UPI transactions/month on the app, investing-aware but never activated any investment product.	Has a monthly budget spreadsheet with a line item labelled "Investing - TBD" that has been blank for several months. Has decided investing belongs in her plan but has never activated it.	Female, 30 - 35, Hyderabad, ₹60K - ₹75K/month, married.
P4	Salaried adult, 22 - 35, Tier 1 or Tier 2 city, ₹25K - ₹80K/month, 15+ UPI transactions/month on the app, investing-aware but never activated any investment product.	Reviews UPI transaction history at month-end, feels surprised by small-purchase spend, then closes the app without acting. Awareness of spending has never translated into investing action.	Male, 23 - 26, Jaipur, ₹25K - ₹35K/month, lives with family.
P5	Salaried adult, 22 - 35, Tier 1 or Tier 2 city, ₹25K - ₹80K/month, 15+ UPI transactions/month on the app, investing-aware but	Sets aside money on salary day for specific goals but does not want to make a decision about where to invest it. Already saves regularly	Female, 27 - 30, Mumbai, ₹50K - ₹65K/month, supports family financially.

	never activated any investment product.	but treats investing as a separate, more complicated category.	
P6	Salaried adult, 22 - 35, Tier 1 or Tier 2 city, ₹25K - ₹80K/month, 15+ UPI transactions/month on the app, investing-aware but never activated any investment product.	Already rounds up expenses mentally when making UPI payments but has never converted that mental habit into an actual investing action. Thinks in small savings increments without acting on them.	Female, 30 - 35, Lucknow, ₹60K/month, married, two-person household.

D3 · Validation, per hypothesis

VALIDATION BLOCK HYP01

Method: Interview

Hypothesis: The target user is a salaried adult, 22–35, Tier 1/2 city, ₹25K–₹80K/month, 15+ UPI transactions/month, investing-aware but never activated.

Persona ID	Specific user details	Notes from session	Observations	Validation outcome	Validation notes
P1	Transfers month-end surplus to savings but never invests; perceives investable amount as too small.				
P2	Has researched mutual funds and watched investing videos; consistently stalls at the decision point.				
P3	Maintains a budget spreadsheet with "Investing (TBD)" blank for several months; intent exists, action doesn't.				
P4	Reviews UPI history at month-end, registers surprise at spend, closes				

	the app without acting.				
P5	Sets aside savings on salary day for specific goals; treats investing as a separate, more complex activity.				
P6	Mentally rounds up UPI payments already; has never converted that mental habit into investing action.				

Validation outcome options: supports / contradicts / new finding

VALIDATION BLOCK HYP02

Method: Interview

Hypothesis: The barrier to investing is not lack of interest but lack of a low-effort entry point. The decision about which app, which fund, and how much keeps getting deprioritised.

Persona ID	Specific user details	Notes from session	Observations	Validation outcome	Validation notes
P1	Postpones investing because the amount feels too small to justify the effort of a deliberate decision.				
P2	Gets stuck specifically at the decision point despite knowledge and intent. Paralysis by choice, not ignorance.				
P3	Has already decided investing belongs in her plan; the missing piece is not motivation but activation.				
P4	Awareness of spending patterns exists but has never triggered an investing decision. The translation step is broken.				

P5	Saves actively but treats investing as requiring a separate, harder class of decision than saving.				
P6	Already thinks in small savings increments mentally; the gap is converting a passive habit into an active one.				

Validation outcome options: supports / contradicts / new finding

VALIDATION BLOCK HYP03

Method: Interview + Design method

Hypothesis: A good outcome for the user is feeling like they became an investor without making a difficult financial decision. The emotional win is discovering an accumulated corpus. The measurable win is watching a real number grow from existing transactions without deliberate effort.

Sub-table A: Interview

Persona ID	Specific user details	Notes from session	Observations	Validation outcome	Validation notes
P1	Wants to feel she has started, not that she has made a smart financial move. Outcome orientation over process orientation.				
P2	Has the knowledge but not the emotional readiness to commit. Validates whether "starting without deciding" resolves the block.				
P3	Already frames investing as a line item in her plan; tests whether a passive corpus creation satisfies or feels insufficient.				
P4	Motivated by visible				

	progress. The growing number hypothesis maps directly to his month-end transaction review habit.				
P5	Already goal-oriented with savings; tests whether a Round-Up corpus feels like a legitimate goal or a trivial amount.				
P6	Mental rounding habit is the closest existing analogue. Tests whether the digital version delivers the same satisfaction.				

Sub-table B: Design method

Persona ID	Specific user details	Notes from session	Observations	Validation outcome	Validation notes
P1	Tests whether seeing ₹2,340 accumulated on screen creates the emotional win described in the goals hypothesis.				
P2	Tests whether the accumulated balance screen resolves the decision paralysis or raises new questions about the fund.				
P3	Tests whether the corpus number feels meaningful to someone who already has a structured savings plan.				
P4	Tests whether the balance screen delivers the same satisfaction as his month-end UPI history review.				
P5	Tests whether a passive				

	corpus competes with or complements her existing goal-based savings behaviour.				
P6	Tests whether the digital execution of her existing mental rounding habit lands as intuitive or feels different in practice.				

Validation outcome options: supports / contradicts / new finding

VALIDATION BLOCK HYP04

Method: Design method

Hypothesis: The Round-Up auto-deduction mechanism does not trigger a trust or security concern when surfaced correctly. Users with no prior investing experience will read an auto-deduction notification as a feature confirmation, not a fraud or security alert.

Persona ID	Specific user details	Notes from session	Observations	Validation outcome	Validation notes
P1	Has no auto-deduction experience beyond standard UPI. Highest risk of reading the notification as unexpected money movement.				
P2	Financially informed but has never invested. Tests whether knowledge reduces or has no effect on the trust reaction.				
P3	Budget-conscious and structured. Tests whether automatic deduction feels like a loss of control to a deliberate planner.				
P4	Already passively monitors money movement; tests whether the notification reads as alarming or expected				

	given that habit.				
P5	Has existing auto-deductions for goals; tests whether prior experience with automatic money movement normalises the Round-Up deduction.				
P6	Already mentally rounds up; tests whether the automatic version of her own existing habit feels trustworthy or intrusive.				

Validation outcome options: supports / contradicts / new finding

D4 · Final decision

Hypothesis ID	Next step	Next-step explanation
HYP01	To be filled post-research	Proceed if 4 or more of 6 interviews confirm the profile: salaried, payment-active, investing-aware, never activated, and primary mental model is payments not financial products. More validation needed if the profile is confirmed but the behavioural pattern (15+ UPI transactions per month, never opened investing) does not hold consistently across personas. Invalidate if users do not identify with the payment-primary mental model, or if a majority have already activated some investment product, meaning the addressable segment is smaller or differently defined than hypothesised.
HYP02	To be filled post-research	Proceed if 4 or more of 6 interviews confirm that the barrier is decision friction, not financial distress, not lack of awareness, not distrust of investing, and users can articulate a specific moment where the decision felt too effortful to complete. More validation needed if the barrier exists but its nature is inconsistent across personas. For example, if some users cite decision friction while others cite distrust of platforms or lack of surplus, the problem is more fragmented than one mechanic can solve. Invalidate if users do not express latent investing intent at all, or if the primary barrier is something the Round-Up mechanic cannot address, such as active distrust of the platform or a strong preference for manual control over money.
HYP03	To be	Proceed if both the interview and design method sub-tables

	filled post- research	converge: interviews confirm users want to feel like investors without making a deliberate decision, and the design method confirms that seeing an accumulated corpus number on screen delivers that emotional outcome without triggering questions about fund choice or withdrawal access. More validation needed if interviews support the emotional goal but the design method shows mixed reactions to the accumulated balance. For example, if users find the number too small to feel meaningful, or immediately ask how to withdraw it, the goal hypothesis may be right but the mechanic needs adjustment. Invalidate if users require fund understanding or manual control before feeling satisfied, meaning passive accumulation alone does not deliver the emotional outcome and the feature premise needs rethinking.
HYP04	To be filled post- research	Proceed if 4 or more of 6 design method sessions show users reading the auto-deduction notification as a feature confirmation, not a fraud alert, not a security concern, and not a reason to turn the feature off. More validation needed if reactions split, with some users comfortable and others alarmed. A trust failure at any meaningful scale is a product-level risk that needs resolution before build, and this is a higher bar than the other hypotheses because trust failures are harder to recover from post-launch than a misread emotional outcome. Invalidate if a majority of users express alarm, compare the notification to a fraud or OTP alert, or say they would immediately turn the feature off upon seeing an automatic deduction. An invalidated HYP04 does not necessarily kill the feature. It may redirect toward a consent-first variant, but it requires a manager conversation before proceeding.

D5 · Connect it to Claude

Connector used: Google Drive Integration (via Claude's built-in connector)

Document location:

<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1tUGD9TDWC5jvmPTNDzJ3upuV08Ofv8W8GG8feWuKAFg/edit?usp=sharing>

What the document contains:

This Google Doc holds the full findings sheet for the Round-Up Investing opportunity validation. It includes the four hypotheses (HYP01 to HYP04), the six user personas (P1 to P6), the validation method plan (interview guide and vibe-prototype scope), and the D3 observation tables structured for live data entry during and after each session.

Proof of connection:

The screenshot below shows Claude (Haiku 4.5) successfully reading the document after the Google Drive connector was activated. Claude correctly identified and summarised all four hypotheses, the validation plan structure (6 interviews plus design method), and the current state of the D3 tables. This confirms the connector is live and the findings sheet is accessible to Claude for ongoing analysis as research progresses.

I've connected my Google Drive. Can you read my findings sheet at <https://docs.google.com/document/d/1tUGD9TDWC5jvmPTNDzJ3upuV08Ofv8W8G88feWukAFg/edit?usp=sharing>

Read a page, loaded tools, used Google Drive integration >

Got it. This is your **Assignment 02: Validate the Opportunity** for the Ayuda Flagship Program — an opportunity validation for "Round-Up Investing," a feature on a consumer payments app that automatically invests spare change from UPI transactions.

Let me summarize the key sections:

The Feature: Round-Up Investing proposes that every UPI payment gets rounded up to the next ₹10, with the spare change automatically invested into a low-risk fund. The pitch is to convert payment-only users (who haven't started investing) into first-time investors through a frictionless, passive mechanism.

Your Hypotheses (organized across the document):

- **HYP01:** Target user profile—salaried 22–35 year-olds in Tier 1–2 cities (₹25–80K/month), high-frequency UPI users, investing-aware but never activated, perceive spare change as too trivial to invest deliberately.
- **HYP02:** The core problem is decision friction (which fund? which app? how much?), not lack of interest.
- **HYP03:** Success = users feel like investors without making a hard decision; the emotional win is watching a corpus grow passively.
- **HYP04:** Automatic deductions won't trigger trust/security concerns if presented correctly.

Your Validation Plan:

- **6 user interviews** (already scoped with personas P1–P6, screening questions, and a staged interview guide)
- **Design method** with a vibe-prototype showing 4 screens: opt-in toggle, payment completion with round-up deduction, notification, and accumulated balance
- Interview focus: validate problem existence and behavioural patterns
- Design method focus: test whether the mechanism feels intuitive and trustworthy

What's Strong: Your hypothesis scaffolding is tight. The problem hypothesis is well-anchored (you cite Jar's 10M+ users, Groww's success, Reddit discussions). Your user personas have "peculiar habits" that differentiate them, and your interview guide is detailed with specific prompts and a rewritten Q block that applies the Ayuda Question Rewriter framework.

What's in Progress: The validation tables (D3) are structured but empty—you have rows for each persona and hypothesis, but no "Notes from session" or "Observations" filled in yet. These are ready for you to fill in as you conduct the interviews and design sessions.

What I can help with: Do you want me to help you prepare for the interviews (refine prompts, anticipate follow-ups), build or refine the vibe-prototype design, or something else?

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+ Write a message...

